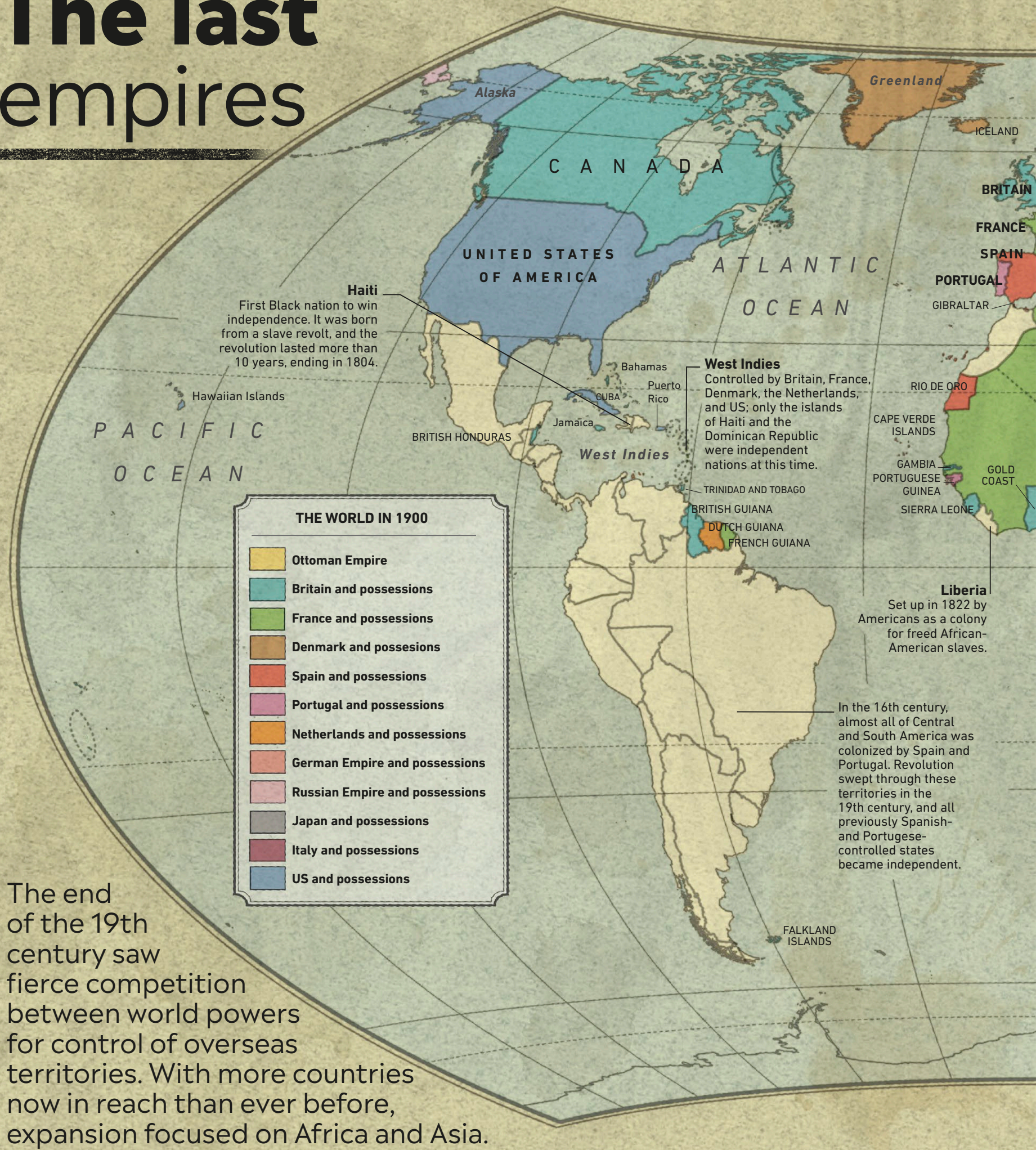


The last empires



The end of the 19th century saw fierce competition between world powers for control of overseas territories. With more countries now in reach than ever before, expansion focused on Africa and Asia.